

always bite the hand that feeds you

It's like this buzzing. It starts slowly, so slowly you don't even notice it, creeping up on you like the hazy sensation of falling asleep. Maybe it's more like ropes around your legs that you've forgotten were there, that someone convinced you weren't there, as they've been gripping you through generations. So you look down, and you want to scream, because you don't belong to you anymore. You're someone else.

But don't worry, I promise I'll

Smile: it's an easy thing to fake.

if you cared to look closer, you'd see the shadow of a grimace, following me around, always.

The constant weight on my back, my hands, my chest. But you'll just walk on by, by the dead girl on the sidewalk. (I'll never let you see what I do to myself.)

at night I'm ripping out my own organs because

In this world

we have to claw out our own spaces.

I hope growing up means I can leave you. I hope that growing up means that the pain in my chest starts to disappear. That my foggy headaches and clicking wrists no longer need to protect me from you. When you're gone, I think it'll be a relief more than anything (I know, I feel guilty too). As a child, I saw you burning. But how would it feel? To kill something that's already hurting itself?

We've lived here a long time, basking in each other's toxicity, until we forgot what the real world was like, until we both forgot what love was, because we'd already defined it. We said that

This

was all that love was.

And isn't that sad?

Suffering is the overgrown garden I lay in, too tired to move. Maybe that's what people mean when they tell me to go outside: to move, to

leave. To stop inhaling your words and your harsh hands and your delusional prayers, and to start exhaling the sickness you gave me. But I'll just sit here, talking nonsense. Telling the people who come after me to always bite the hand that feeds you.